

Correlation Table

TOEIC® Listening and Reading Test Scores and the CEFR levels*

1

Identify the TOTAL minimum score nearest to the achieved score

2

Translate the achieved score into the corresponding CEFR level*

3

Find the general description related to the achieved score

Total minimum score frequently required by higher education and companies

TOTAL minimum scores (10 to 990 pts)	TOEIC Listening minimum score	TOEIC Reading minimum score	CEFR levels		CEFR General Description
84 pts	39	45	Independent user - Threshold	B1	Can understand a wide range of demanding, longer texts, and recognise implicit meaning. Can express him/herself fluently and spontaneously without much obvious searching for expressions. Can use language flexibly and effectively for social, academic and professional purposes. Can produce clear, well-structured, detailed text on complex subjects, showing controlled use of organisational patterns, connectors and cohesive devices.
60 pts	26	34	Basic user - Waystage	A2	Test takers in this score range typically can understand short spoken sentences and a limited range of grammatical structures; they can understand short conversational exchanges on familiar topics. Typically test takers in this score range can understand speech that is clear and slow. They can usually understand key words, formulaic phrases and expressions, and relatively short, sentence-length speech. Generally test takers in this score range can understand spoken language on familiar topics and routines. They understand simple descriptions and information about people, family, shopping, location, and employment. Most of the time, test takers can understand simple sentences and simple grammatical structures, and they may inconsistently understand some complex sentences and structures. Test takers in this score range can occasionally understand implied meanings.
35 pts	16	19	Basic user - Breakthrough	A1	Test takers in this score range typically can understand some slowly spoken words, simple phrases, and short sentences on familiar topics. Test takers in this score range can understand short pieces of speech that are spoken clearly and very slowly. Generally they can understand short formulaic phrases, simple sentences, and simple grammatical structures when common vocabulary is used. They can understand short, predictable messages and instructions on familiar topics. They can understand unconnected speech, one sentence at a time.

* CEFR: The Common European Framework of Reference for Languages outlines an ascending series of common reference levels for describing learner proficiency. This CEFR describes both knowledge and skills in positive "can-do" statements at six levels of proficiency for different language skills from A1 level (Basic User - Breakthrough) to C2 level (Proficient User - Mastery).

The benchmarking study of the TOEIC® Listening and Reading scores to the Common European Framework of Reference (CEFR) was conducted by Tannenbaum, R.J., & Wylie, E.C-2006. The results of the standard setting are recommended minimum score requirements, or cut scores. The mapping of TOEIC test scores to each CEFR level in this particular study are presented as guidelines for minimum thresholds for each level. ETS does not recommend to use the minimum cut scores strictly. For more information about this study please contact us at cef@etsglobal.org.

N.B: For A1 to B1 levels ETS advises to take the TOEIC Bridge® Test.

TOEIC® Listening and Reading scores are reported in 5-point increments.

For more information about the TOEIC® Listening and Reading test:

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TOEIC® Listening and Reading Test Score Descriptors

TOTAL TOEIC Listening and Reading score (from 10 to 990 points) =

Listening part + Reading part

(from 5 to 495 points) ▼

▼ (from 5 to 495 points)

LISTENING

Level	Strengths	Weaknesses
84-100 points	Test takers who score around 84-100 typically have the following strengths: ■ Test takers in this score range typically can understand short spoken conversations and monologues made up of connected sentences and some complex structures. ■ They can understand some implied meaning and some abstract ideas. They can usually understand a range of common vocabulary and some complex sentences and grammatical structures. ■ Typically test takers can understand concrete topics and some abstract ideas related to work and other familiar contexts. ■ Test takers understand some implied meanings and can connect facts in conversations and short spoken monologues with information in a short written text.	Test takers who receive a score at this level typically have weaknesses only when uncommon grammar or vocabulary is used.
60-83 points	Test takers who score around 60-83 typically have the following strengths: ■ Test takers in this score range typically can understand some slowly spoken words, simple phrases, and short sentences on familiar topics. ■ Test takers in this score range can understand short pieces of speech that are spoken clearly and very slowly. ■ Generally they can understand short formulaic phrases, simple sentences, and simple grammatical structures when common vocabulary is used. ■ They can understand short, predictable messages and instructions on familiar topics. They can understand unconnected speech, one sentence at a time.	Test takers who score around 300 typically have the following weaknesses: ■ They have difficulty understanding the central idea, purpose, and basic context of short spoken exchanges when conversational responses are indirect or difficult to predict or when the vocabulary is difficult. ■ They do not understand the central idea, purpose, and basic context of extended spoken texts when it is necessary to connect information within the text or when difficult vocabulary is used. ■ They do not understand details in short spoken exchanges when language is syntactically complex or when difficult vocabulary is used. They do not usually understand details that include negative constructions. ■ They do not understand details in extended spoken texts when it is necessary to connect information across the text or when the information is not supported by repetition. They do not understand most paraphrased information or difficult grammatical constructions.
35-59 points	Test takers who score around 35-59 typically have the following strengths: ■ Test takers in this score range typically can understand some slowly spoken words, simple phrases, and short sentences on familiar topics. ■ Test takers in this score range can understand short pieces of speech that are spoken clearly and very slowly. ■ Generally they can understand short formulaic phrases, simple sentences, and simple grammatical structures when common vocabulary is used. ■ They can understand short, predictable messages and instructions on familiar topics. They can understand unconnected speech, one sentence at a time.	Test takers who score around 200 typically have the following weaknesses: ■ They do not understand the central idea, purpose, or basic context of short spoken exchanges, even when the language is direct and no unexpected information is present. ■ They do not understand the central idea, purpose, and basic context of extended spoken texts when it is necessary to connect information across the text or when the vocabulary is somewhat difficult. ■ They do not understand details in short spoken exchanges when somewhat difficult vocabulary is used or when the language is syntactically complex. They do not understand details that include negative constructions. ■ They do not understand details in extended spoken texts when the requested information is heard in the middle of the text. They do not understand paraphrased information or difficult grammatical constructions.

READING

Level	Strengths	Weaknesses
≈ 450 points	Test takers who score around 450 typically have the following strengths: ■ They can infer the central idea and purpose of a written text, and they can make inferences about details. ■ They can read for meaning. They can understand factual information, even when it is paraphrased. ■ They can connect information across an entire text, and they can make connections between two related texts. ■ They can understand a broad range of vocabulary, unusual meanings of common words, and idiomatic usage. They can also make distinctions between the meanings of closely related words. ■ They can understand rule-based grammatical structures. They can also understand difficult, complex, and uncommon grammatical constructions.	Test takers who score around 450 typically have weaknesses only when the information tested is particularly dense or involves difficult vocabulary.
≈ 350 points	Test takers who score around 350 typically have the following strengths: ■ They can infer the central idea and purpose of a written text, and they can make inferences about details. ■ They can read for meaning. They can understand factual information, even when it is paraphrased. ■ They can connect information across a small area within a text, even when the vocabulary and grammar of the text are difficult. ■ They can understand medium-level vocabulary. They can sometimes understand difficult vocabulary in context, unusual meanings of common words, and idiomatic usage. ■ They can understand rule-based grammatical structures. They can also understand difficult, complex, and uncommon grammatical constructions.	Test takers who score around 350 typically have the following weaknesses: ■ They do not connect information across a wide area within a text. ■ They do not consistently understand difficult vocabulary, unusual meanings of common words, or idiomatic usage. They usually cannot make distinctions between the meanings of closely related words.
≈ 250 points	Test takers who score around 250 typically have the following strengths: ■ They can make simple inferences based on a limited amount of text. ■ They can locate the correct answer to a factual question when the language of the text matches the information that is required. They can sometimes answer a factual question when the answer is a simple paraphrase of the information in the text. ■ They can sometimes connect information within one or two sentences. ■ They can understand easy vocabulary, and they can sometimes understand medium-level vocabulary. ■ They can understand common, rule-based grammatical structures. They can make correct grammatical choices, even when other features of language, such as difficult vocabulary or the need to connect information, are present.	Test takers who score around 250 typically have the following weaknesses: ■ They do not understand inferences that require paraphrase or connecting information. ■ They have a very limited ability to understand factual information expressed as a paraphrase using difficult vocabulary. They often depend on finding words and phrases in the text that match the same words and phrases in the question. ■ They usually do not connect information beyond two sentences. ■ They do not understand difficult vocabulary, unusual meanings of common words, or idiomatic usage. They usually cannot make distinctions between the meanings of closely related words. ■ They do not understand more-difficult, complex, or uncommon grammatical constructions.
≈ 150 points	Test takers who score around 150 typically have the following strengths: ■ They can locate the correct answer to a factual question when not very much reading is necessary and when the language of the text matches the information that is required. ■ They can understand easy vocabulary and common phrases. ■ They can understand the most-common, rule-based grammatical constructions when not very much reading is necessary.	Test takers who score around 150 typically have the following weaknesses: ■ They cannot make inferences about information in written texts. ■ They do not understand paraphrased factual information. They rely on matching words and phrases in the text to answer questions. ■ They are often unable to connect information even within a single sentence. ■ They understand only a limited range of vocabulary. ■ They do not understand even easy grammatical constructions when other language features, such as difficult vocabulary or the need to connect information, are also required.